

ONWONG'A JAPHET (O.J)



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2011/2012

INSTITUTIONAL BASED PROGRAMME (IBP) – DECEMBER SESSION
EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF EDUCATION (ARTS)
ALT 201: EAST AFRICAN POETRY AND DRAMA

DATE: Thursday, 3rd May, 2012

TIME: 11.00 a.m. – 1.00 p.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer **THREE** questions. Question **ONE** is Compulsory. Answer ONE question from Section A and **ONE** from Section B.

Avoid duplication of material.

1. **COMPULSORY**

“By both its stylistic approach and thematic concerns, East Africa poetry can be said to be resistance poetry.” Basing your response on Okot P’Bitek’s Song of Lawino, discuss the truth of this statement. (26 marks)

SECTION A

2. Using suitable illustrations, discuss how post-independent East African poets have dealt with the issues of the city and morality. (22 marks)
3. Assess the truth of the following statement using illustrations from at least two poems: “East African poetry has often been talked of as if it represents a communal voice, and as if it is one identical mass but this is not always the case.” (22 marks)

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SECTION B

4. Discuss how Ngugi wa Thiong'o and Micere Githae Mugo in *The Trials of Dedan Kimathi* or Hussein Ebrahim in *Kinjeketile* handle history. (22 marks)

5. Argue for or against the observation that the fate of the characters in John Ruganda's *The Floods* is closely tied to the dramatic techniques he uses. (22 marks)

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